



FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS (FAQ) FOR CENSUS 2027-HLO PHASE

For Enumerators and Supervisors



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FAQs on Question Numbers 2, 3, 7 and 9 i.e. Building Number, Census House Number, Use of Census House and Household number

- 1. If government has provided residential shelters to residents, four in single line. LPG, ration and electricity connection are different. The families (brothers) demolished the walls or even otherwise, they are cooking in common kitchen. Now whether all these brothers with families would constitute single household or not. And if single household, whether all the demolished partition wall would constitute single building and single census house.**

Household is defined as a group of persons who normally live together and take their meals from a common kitchen. In this case, all the 4 families are taking meal from a common kitchen and will form one household. It hardly matters how many connections they have. Hence, it is a single building and a single household, the question of more than 1 census house will not arise.

- 2. If a person sleeps in the Shop (Ghani) at night and only goes to his house to take meal, then, whether the shop be treated as normal HH?**

In this case, shop should be non-residential and place where he is taking meal should be considered his normal HH.

- 3. In commercial areas/public houses, we find houses where people sleep at night on payment basis. The persons may or may not cook there. Should we list the households/persons or treat these houses as non-residential and the persons as houseless?**

No, they will not be houseless. These houses and households will be covered in Houselisting phase also. There may be offices/ shops where people will also sleep, e.g., guard, etc. If a person does not have a regular place of residence and is staying or sleeping in such buildings or houses, those houses should be recorded as residence-cum-shop, residence-cum-office, or as applicable.

- 4. At a place, building number 74 has been demolished by the municipality while building numbers 73 and 75, also numbered by the municipality exist. How to record the building number in layout map and Schedule?**

In cases where systematic numbering exists, the same may be adopted. Systematic numbering does not mean that in all places, the number will start with 1 at the north-west corner. It means that building numbers, provided by the local authority, exists for most of the buildings in the Houselisting Block. However, in cases where systematic numbering does not exist, the enumerator may number the buildings starting with CN1 at the north-west corner.

In this example, in both layout map and Schedule, Building No. 75 will be recorded after Building No. 73.

5. The hostel and school are in the same building. How this is to be recorded?

There can be two separate census houses in the same building, if there are separate main entrances from the road, common courtyard etc. to the Hostel and School. Otherwise, it should be treated as one census house “Residence-cum-School”

6. If a PG is registered and candidates themselves prepare the food, should they all be considered as a separate HH?

In such a scenario, definition of household should take priority. Suppose in a registered PG of 60 people, if 30 people take food from a common kitchen while 30 people either prepare food on their own or take their meals from outside. Then in such a scenario, there will be one institutional household with 30 members and 30 normal households with one member each.

7. In Instruction manual, it is written as if buildings are numbered systematically by the Municipal or local authority, it should be adopted. Whether building numbers assigned by CPWD/State PWD or any other authority controlling the residential area can be adopted, if such numbering is systematic and covers the entire block??

Yes

FAQs on Question Numbers 4, 5, 6 and 8 i.e. Predominant material of Floor, Wall & Roof and Condition of Census house

8. If a person is staying in a rented house and the wall is plastered and painted how to know the real material of the wall?

In case of confusion, may be asked from the landlord or housing society. Type of inner material must be ensured as it is an important indicator for deciding Kutcha or Pucca houses. If it is not able to ascertain, select option ‘Any Other’

9. In case two different rooms have different material of ceiling which material needs to be selected as material of the roof.

Select the material out of which the major portion of the roof of the house is made. Do not take inside false ceiling. In a multi-storey building, select the roof material directly above your own floor or flat. If the roof has more than one material, choose the material that covers the maximum area.

- 10. The roof of 5th floor is concrete, but roof of the 10th topmost floor is made of asbestos sheets in the same building. Then what will be the material of roof. Is it Concrete or asbestos sheets?**

If it is a single census house, then roof of top floor to be considered. If these are different census houses, for census house at 5th floor, material of roof will be concrete whereas for census house at 10th floor, material of roof will be asbestos sheet.

- 11. The roof of the house is covered with Khaprail. But any such option under material of the roof is not there. Which one should be selected?**

Khaprail/Kavelu/Khapra are traditional, handmade roofing tiles, also known as "country tiles". Select the option 'Handmade tiles' in this case.

FAQs on Question Number 10 i.e. Question on Total number of persons normally residing in this household

- 12. If any child is staying away in other city for studies. Should she/he be counted for total number of persons normally residing in the family?**

If child does not live with normally for most of the year in the household, then should not be counted in this household. Child will be counted at her normal place of stay.

- 13. In the first visit, if it is a locked house, what to do?**

During the first visit, the building number, census house number, etc., should be recorded or generated, and the checkbox for a locked house (as provided in Question 7) must be ticked to ensure the house is not missed. The Enumerator may inquire with neighbors about the household's availability and plan subsequent visits accordingly. Details of the household can be filled in once the household is available. For this purpose, the previously generated record marked as "locked" should be retrieved and completed. If the house remains locked until the last date of fieldwork, it will be considered as a locked house.

- 14. Will tenants be considered as part of the owner household?**

No. The tenant will be considered as separate household provided he/she takes meals separately from a separate kitchen or taking meal from outside. If the tenant is taking food along with owner's household from a common kitchen, then he/she will be a member of the owner's household.

- 15. During the entire period of HLO field operations, summer vacation will be observed in Government/Private hostels (institutional households), and students will go back to their homes. Whether such students should be counted as members of the hostel (institutional household) or not?**

Students will be considered hostels as the criteria for no of members are persons generally living in that household. So, the number of students generally living in that hostel may be recorded

FAQ on Question Number 13 (SC/ST or Other)

16. How to fill column of SC/ST if the person belongs to different caste/tribe, which is not listed as SC/ST in that State?

Each State and Union Territory has its own notified list of Scheduled Castes (SC) and Scheduled Tribes (ST). The State specific lists of SCs and STs will be available in the mobile App in pdf form. If the name reported by the respondent does not exist then enumerate the respondent as Other, i.e. not as SC or ST.

17. If a person is shifted from place A to place B belonging to caste 'X' which is not SC in place A but SC in place B, then whether he will be enumerated as SC in place B?

If the person is enumerated in B and his caste is in the SC list of place B, he will be enumerated as SC. Only the place of enumeration is considered for caste. From where he is shifted is not a criterion.

FAQ for Question Number 14 i.e. Ownership Status of this house

18. If the father is head of the household & staying with his child in house owned by child what will be recorded in ownership status of this house question?

Code1- Owned, the census house in which the household lives is owned by any member of that household. / Ownership may belong to the head of the household or any other member of the household living there.

19. If the father is head of the household and has own house in a village but presently staying with child in house given by child's company what will be recorded in ownership status of this house question?

Code2- Rented but has own house elsewhere.

20. In answering Question number14, is it necessary to tell rented but has own house elsewhere or not?

As per census Act 1948, Section 8: every person of whom any question is asked under sub-section (1) shall be legally bound to answer such question to the best of his knowledge or belief.

21. If four office colleagues are staying together in a rented accommodation and taking meals from common kitchen whose ownership status is to be recorded?

The ownership status of the Census house occupied by any of the four members of the household will be shown under this question i.e code 2 or code 3 as the case may be.

22. Who will come under “Any Other” option in ownership status of this house?

In some cases, the ownership of either of the land or of the structure does not belong to the household i.e., houses either constructed on encroached land in un-regularized slums or anywhere else. Also, the household may be living in unauthorized manner in abandoned buildings, building under construction or accommodation provided free of charge by employers (apart from accommodation provided by government to public servants, civil servants, MPs etc) etc., All these cases will come under Any other option.

23. Accommodation provided to government servant will come under which category in Question number 14?

Accommodation provided to government servant for which some allowance is deducted from salary will come under rented option Code 2 or 3 as the case may be.

24. A person is staying in his/her father’s house and his/her father is not staying with him/her. That person is not paying any rent for that house. In that condition what will be the code of ownership of house regarding question no 14?

If the Household is not making payments in the form of rent to anyone, then the Household may be considered as living in owned house and Code 1 may be given.

25. A person lives in a rented house but have parental house elsewhere. In the ‘Ownership Status of this house’ What should be selected?

A person who lives in a rented house but have his own house elsewhere in India, either parental or own purchased, select ‘rented but has own house elsewhere’ from the options.

FAQ on Question Number 15 i.e. Number of Dwelling rooms

26. If I have store room converted to study room for kids, will that be counted as separate dwelling room?

Yes, It should be counted as a dwelling room.

FAQ on Question Number 16 i.e. number of married couples living in this household

27. If spouse is not staying during house listing period will that couple be included in recording Number of married couple(s) living in this household?

If the spouse is normal resident of that household, that couple will be counted as part of that household.

FAQ on Question Number 17 i.e. Main source of drinking water

28. If a well is located outside the household premises and supplies water through taps to multiple households without any treatment, how should the source of drinking water be recorded?

In this case, the source of drinking water should be recorded as Tap water from an untreated source.

29. If packaged bottled water is used even though tap water is available. What option should be selected?

'Packaged/Bottled Water', as it is your main source of drinking water.

FAQ on Question Number 19 i.e. Main source of lighting

30. In the case of on-grid solar, whether the "Main source of lighting" should be recorded as electricity or solar.

On-grid solar systems (also called grid-tied systems) absolutely should be categorized as solar energy because they are fundamentally based on the conversion of sunlight into electricity.

FAQs on Question Numbers 20 to 23 i.e. Access to latrine, Type of latrine, Waste water connected to and Bathing facility

31. In some places, houses have a latrine system of flush/pour flush connected to a ventilated/improved pit (not septic tank). What will be the code of 'Type of Latrine' in this case i.e. for question number 21?

The answer for this will be Code 3 (Other system)

32. In urban areas, many households have more than one latrine, which type is to be recorded?

The type of latrine used mainly by majority of household members is to be recorded.

33. Some households in villages construct latrines in a nearby plot outside their home due to space constraint or other reasons. How to code these toilets?

If the latrine is used exclusively by the household or jointly by a limited set of households and they control its access, it will be considered as if they have latrine

34. If the waste water goes to a soak pit outside. What should be recorded in question on waste water outlet connected to?

If the pipe is connected to the soak pit, record Closed Drainage.

If water flows directly without a pipe, record No Drainage.

35. A household is using waste water for plants in the garden. What will be the code for Question number 22?

If drainage system exists and the household has made additional arrangements for redirecting the water to garden, the existing drainage system will be considered for coding. Otherwise, assign no drainage.

36. If household has bathroom and always taking bath in open, then under bathing facility what should be recorded for Question number 23?

Option 1 - Yes, due to the availability of the facility.

FAQs on Question Numbers 26 to 30

37. Advance mobile phones have facilities similar to TV, laptop, etc. Will these facilities be considered also for recording possession of TV/Laptop etc. in the given questions?

No, actual possession of TV/Computer is necessary for entry in these questions.

38. If household is watching TV using fire stick, which option will be recorded in Question number 27?

Fire stick, Chrome cast etc. are devices used to watch programmes on internet on TV like youtube, amazon prime, Netflix etc. Record Any Other - 4

FAQs on Question Numbers 31 and 32

39. Will the three wheelers like motorized cycle van, auto rickshaw, e-rickshaw tempo, etc. be considered as Two-Wheeler/Four-Wheeler? Similarly, will tractors, etc. be considered as car?

Three wheelers like motorized cycle van, auto rickshaw, e-rickshaw tempo, etc. are not recorded either as 'Two-Wheeler' and 'Four-Wheeler'.

Tractor is not recorded in Census. The question checks the availability of Car/Jeep/Van types of vehicles only.

40. Two households use the same car. How it will be recorded?

It will be recorded against the household who has custody of the car and controls its use.

41. Will the Car/Jeep use for commercial purpose also be considered as available?

Yes, they will be considered as available even if they are used for mainly commercial purposes.

42. I am a car driver and the car belongs to my owner, however, the car is usually kept with me and during emergency; I use the car for my family purpose. In that condition availability of assets and amenities what will be the code for question no 32?

In this case (Code 1) i.e. yes may be given.

FAQs on Question Numbers 33 and 34

43. A family eats more than one cereal (like rice and wheat). Which one should be recorded?

Record the cereal that is consumed most often by the household.

44. Whose mobile number is to be given?

Mobile number of any member of the household which is active for receiving census related communication needs to be recorded. However, in case of locked/vacant Census Houses, if mobile number of any member of Household is available from the neighbour(s), it needs to be recorded.

45. If household has no mobile, then can neighbours number be given for census related communication?

No.

Questions on MAP

46. A building has municipality allotted numbers on each flat. How to show this in the layout map?

Assume that the entire structure is pucca. Then, the entire structure (building with all the flats) may be drawn as a big square and each flat inside it may be shown separately as smaller squares inside that big square. Building number may be written on each small square and each small square may be kept white or hatched depending on whether the flat is used as residence or the flat is wholly non-residential.

However, in case of big buildings where there are a large number of flats and it is difficult to draw each flat within the building in the Map, a single square showing all the Census house numbers e.g. from house number 1 to 50 in the building on the Map is to be drawn.